

Quality Management System Manual

Example Ltd

ISO 9001:2015 · Stage 1 Foundation

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1. Quality Policy

Installed systems must function safely, meet specified performance, and pass all inspections the first time. Example Ltd's whole approach is based on making sure that work is carried out right first time, with minimal snagging and no need for rework after handover. Maintaining our reputation as a reliable subcontractor in a tightly programmed sector, where clients rely on us to avoid delays, is non-negotiable.

From the contract tender through to the handover of commissioning documentation, our processes are structured to prevent repeat work and ensure compliance with all regulations relevant to building services — especially BS 7671 for electrical work, Gas Safe rules for mechanical jobs, and CDM regulations on all sites. The company uses a stepwise workflow where planning, procurement, installation, and certification tasks are scheduled and tracked, making visible when a key step is in danger of being missed or rushed.

Quality is formally checked at key stages: materials are reconciled against specification and delivery notes on arrival; site crews are briefed in advance by the site manager; and installations are inspected at each major stage — notably after first fix, second fix, and final fix. The final phase includes a formal walkthrough to catch potential snags before the main contractor's review. Test certification and commissioning paperwork are completed as part of the job, not after-the-fact, ensuring that all required documents are ready at handover without scramble.

Site operatives' competence is maintained through continuous checking of certs (CSCS/ECS/gas tickets), ongoing monitoring of calibration status for critical tools and plant, and safe systems of work. Delivery and admin processes deliberately build in enough margin to allow for typical disruptions but are tracked closely to avoid cumulative delays. Where a mistake or nonconformity is reported, the company logs, investigates, and methodically closes out corrective action. Insights from recurring issues inform changes to process or training, rather than being dealt with only as one-off fixes.

Ultimately, we stake our future workload on being a subcontractor that the main contractor trusts: we keep to programme, we do the job right, we don't cause compliance problems or last-minute headaches, and we produce the correct paperwork on time. This policy is explained to all staff, including site operatives and office support, and is reviewed annually as part of the management cycle, or earlier if required by major client or regulatory changes.

2. Quality Objectives

The company's primary quality objectives are directly linked to operational risk and customer requirements. These metrics are discussed at management reviews and drive improvements across installation quality, documentation, and delivery reliability.

- By the end of 2026, we aim to complete at least 95% of projects to the agreed programme date. At present, this is at approximately 80%. This target reflects the practical need to coordinate with main contractors, avoid reputation-damaging delays, and minimise resource conflicts.
- Snagging items raised at handover are to be reduced to an average of 10 or fewer per job by the end of 2026 (from a current average of about 20). Progress is tracked by reviewing snag lists after internal walkthroughs and formal handover. This figure targets the aspect of work where field teams identify, correct, and proactively prevent issues before client discovery.
- Commissioning and electrical test packs must be completed and signed off in full for 100% of jobs before handover by end 2026, up from a current rate of roughly 60%. Administration and project leadership both monitor completion rates. Any project where handover documentation is incomplete at the agreed date is immediately reviewed post-completion to establish cause and corrective actions.

All objectives are measurable; progress is tracked using job records and close-out documentation. If targets are not met, the management team analyses contributing factors and introduces revised controls, training, or changes in process as appropriate.

3. Scope of the Quality Management System

This quality management system covers Example Ltd's activities relating to the installation and maintenance of heating, ventilation, and electrical systems in commercial buildings. These buildings include schools, NHS sites, office blocks, and small industrial units across the West Midlands and surrounding regions. The company operates both as a subcontractor to main contractors and, for certain projects, as a direct contractor (particularly on public sector and framework contracts).

Included in scope are mechanical (boilers, HVAC plant, pipework, controls) and electrical (distribution boards, wiring, containment, lighting, testing to BS 7671) works. The system covers both new installations and remedial/maintenance work, covering tasks from initial tender through to site mobilisation, installation, inspection, testing, snagging, documentation, and project handover.

Support and administration activities (such as procurement, plant management, document control, and compliance with operative and equipment certs) are included where they impact contract delivery and compliance. Calibration, health and safety, and regulatory documentation related to Gas Safe, CDM, and electrical safety are explicitly covered.

Excluded from the scope are standalone domestic works, activities not requiring commissioning or test certification to standards, and any third-party construction or maintenance works sublet outside the Company's direct management.

4. Process Overview

The company's operational flow divides into three process layers: leadership, core, and support. Leadership processes provide governance, performance review, and ensure compliance with business and regulatory obligations. Core processes cover project delivery, from planning through to handover. Support processes span administration, supplier management, equipment and competence, and document control.

4.1 Leadership Processes

Leadership of the quality system, including all policy and objective setting, falls under the responsibility of the Owner/Managing Director, Gareth Pryce. He convenes periodic management reviews — usually after completion of significant projects or at least annually — to assess whether process performance is on track against objectives and whether changes are required. These reviews are based on actual performance data from project close-outs, review of audit findings, customer and main contractor feedback, and recurring compliance or snagging themes.

Decisions arising from management reviews, such as the introduction of new controls or modifications to workflow, are delegated for implementation to the site, office, and plant managers as appropriate. Leadership also monitors external changes — client requirements (such as the shift to demanding ISO 9001), regulatory shifts (e.g., new CDM or BS 7671 variants), and supply chain issues. Any such changes are cascaded out to the relevant team members via face-to-face meetings or written communication, with adjustments to procedure or training as required.

Leadership is also responsible for allocating resources, whether additional training, equipment calibration budgets, or software. Where risk or performance issues are identified (such as repeated delays or compliance failures), Gareth holds internal reviews involving the affected staff and determines corrective actions to be taken.

4.2 Core Processes

Project Delivery

Every new project commences upon successful tender or contract award. Gareth Pryce decides on go/no-go after reviewing contract terms, programme expectations, and resource commitments. For direct contracts, he also reviews whether any specialist roles (e.g., CDM principal contractor) are required. Pre-start planning is the first operational step: Lee Hammond, as Site Manager, prepares a programme of works, materials and plant schedules, and outlines risk assessments and method statements (RAMS) suitable for the job. Procurement requirements are then passed to Joanne Clarke in the office.

Site mobilisation involves Lee briefing the site crew on programme, design drawings, construction details, health and safety, and recording any operative-specific responsibilities. Installation proceeds in sequenced phases: first fix (containment, cable and pipe routing), second fix (fit-out, connections), and final fix (switches, outlets, plant, controls). Each stage is checked by Lee for conformance to specification, and any issues such as access restrictions, design discrepancies, or materials shortages are escalated back to the office.

Testing and commissioning are integral; electrical works are tested in accordance with BS 7671 and results recorded, while mechanical systems undergo water/pressure, gas tightness, and operational performance checks as applicable. These are not left until end-of-project: if any section fails inspection, it is redone before progressing. Snagging is tackled before formal handover via an internal walkthrough led by Lee and Gareth, allowing all issues within Example Ltd's control to be rectified in advance.

Finally, Joanne and Lee coordinate the completion and signing of all test certificates, commissioning sheets, and O&M manuals. The full documentation pack is checked by Gareth for completeness and compliance before signing off handover to the main contractor or direct client.

Nonconformance and Corrective Action

Any issue, whether identified during project execution or reported by the client or main contractor, triggers the company's issue management sequence. Joanne logs details on receipt and informs Gareth and Lee. Lee investigates on site: cause analysis is expected — was the problem a workmanship error, a missed test, late delivery, or poor instructions? The management team agrees whether an immediate fix or broader process change is needed.

Corrective actions (e.g., repairs, re-tests, revised documentation) are assigned for prompt completion, usually led by Lee or the relevant site operative. Once resolved, Gareth or Lee confirms closure, ensuring the issue is not just patched but prevented from recurring if possible. A

log of all nonconformances is maintained, and any recurring themes (e.g., repeated failures in documentation completion or a persistent materials issue) are escalated for review at the next management meeting.

4.3 Support Processes

Procurement and Supplier Management

Supplier selection is coordinated by Joanne Clarke, using lists built from past performance and recommendations. When a project confirms which materials/plant are needed — as determined by Lee — Joanne raises purchase orders referencing agreed specifications and delivery deadlines. Orders are always placed with adequate lead time based on the site programme.

Deliveries are checked immediately on arrival by a site operative or Lee against the delivery note and agreed specification. Deviations (such as missing, incorrect, or defective items) are flagged to Joanne, who chases the supplier for rapid resolution. If the delivery issue causes risk to the programme, Lee updates Gareth and agrees urgent actions — for example, switching to a different supplier or obtaining equivalent plant from elsewhere.

Joanne periodically reviews supplier performance, including reliability and accuracy of deliveries. If suppliers are consistently substandard, the company ceases further business and updates procurement lists accordingly.

Plant, Equipment, and Operative Competence

All critical test instruments (e.g., MFTs, loop testers, PAT testers), as well as pressure test equipment, are managed centrally by Ricky Obeng. Equipment is checked for presence of in-date calibration stickers before use on site. Calibration is arranged with an external lab at least annually. Ricky tracks calibration status, and if a piece of equipment is out of date, it is pulled from service until recalibrated.

Ricky also tracks competence certification for all operatives: CSCS and ECS cards, Gas Safe registrations, and any required training renewals. Expiring certs are flagged to the relevant individual and line manager at least one month before expiry. Operatives without the proper certifications are never deployed to site.

Administration and Document Control

Joanne oversees job record-keeping and monitors documentation timeliness, particularly for commissioning sheets, test certificates, RAMS, and O&M manuals. She uses dedicated trade software to manage schedules, records, invoicing, and document versions. For projects with CDM duties assigned, the principal contractor/principal designer folders are controlled and maintained within the office.

Waste management compliance is ensured by checking that waste disposal contractors are properly licensed, verified annually.

5. Roles and Responsibilities

The overall responsibility for the Quality Management System sits with Gareth Pryce, Owner and Managing Director. Gareth drives quality culture from the top: he reviews project performance data, sanctions formal corrective actions, determines priorities for improvement, and leads annual management reviews. He makes go/no-go decisions on contracts, approves changes to process, and audits compliance with client and regulatory requirements, including ISO 9001 and sector-specific standards. Gareth also steps in directly in escalations that impact client relationships, handover targets, or major nonconformances.

Lee Hammond, as Site Manager, leads all operational project delivery. He is responsible for planning and sequencing works, briefing the crew, coordinating inspections at each key installation stage, and initiating snagging walkthroughs. Lee takes direct charge of on-site investigations when issues are raised and is the first point of escalation for site-based nonconformances. He collaborates closely with Joanne on procurement and with Ricky on equipment availability and compliance. In Gareth's absence, Lee can take delegated authority for site decisions.

Joanne Clarke, Office Manager, is central to administrative processes. She manages procurement orders, ensures supplier performance, checks materials and paperwork schedules against the programme, and maintains all document control systems. Joanne is the point of contact for incoming issues, logs all reported problems or nonconformances, and oversees document completeness prior to handover. She tracks performance against internal targets and supplies periodic reports to Gareth.

Ricky Obeng, Plant and Equipment Controller, is responsible for the availability and compliance status of all critical test equipment and plant. Ricky keeps an up-to-date register of calibration certificates and manages renewal schedules. He also monitors the status of operatives' site competence and safety cards, flagging upcoming renewals and ensuring non-compliant operatives are not scheduled for work. Ricky provides documentation to Gareth and Lee on request.

All site operatives are expected to follow briefings given by Lee, abide by RAMS, and complete works to the specified standard. They are also responsible for pre-use checks on equipment, highlighting discrepancies or out-of-date certification immediately.

If designated, a Quality Manager (currently not filled as a separate position) would oversee system audits, monitor corrective action follow-up, and coordinate annual reviews, reporting directly to Gareth.

6. Document Control Procedure

All quality system documents, including procedures, inspection records, certificates, commissioning documents, RAMS, and O&M manuals, are controlled via Joanne's document management process. Document creation begins at project start, using company and regulatory templates. Drafts are reviewed by the relevant manager for accuracy and completeness at the appropriate project stage. Final documents (e.g., test certs, handover packs) are checked by Gareth and stored electronically in a structured folder system, with access restricted as appropriate.

Document status (draft, in use, superseded) is marked on electronic or, if used, paper copies. Only the latest controlled versions are distributed for operational use on site or to clients. Amendments arise from regulatory changes, lessons identified, or periodic review. Joanne maintains a record of issue and revision status; superseded documents are archived and access restricted, with a retention period in line with statutory, client, or commercial requirements (typically at least 6 years for installation records).

External documents (such as standards, manufacturer's instructions, or client specifications) are managed in the same electronic library, with source and revision status checked before each job. Paper-based documents on site are returned to the office at project completion for scanning and archiving.

Unauthorised changes, lost documents, or errors found post-issue are reported immediately to Joanne and Gareth for prompt correction and incident logging. All staff are briefed in the procedure for document requests or queries.

7. Internal Audit Procedure

Each year, Gareth schedules at least one full internal audit of the Quality Management System, with scope rotating between project delivery, procurement, compliance (calibration, certification), and document control. Audits may also be triggered by recurring nonconformances, client complaints, or after significant change in process or regulation.

Audit planning involves confirming the scope, selecting the audit lead (usually Gareth or, if independent review is needed, a qualified external or non-operational staff member), and scheduling interviews or site visits. Audits involve reviewing actual job records, talking to responsible staff (e.g., Lee, Joanne, Ricky), and spot-checking operational compliance (e.g., evidence of completed inspections, equipment calibration, material checks).

Findings are logged into an audit report, including recommendations and deadlines for corrective actions. Each finding is tracked through to closure, with Gareth holding the relevant manager accountable for actions. Serious issues trigger an immediate review and may lead to process change. Completed audit reports are reviewed in the next management review.

8. Management Review Procedure

A management review is formally convened annually by Gareth, or earlier if performance against objectives is off track, or after multiple significant nonconformances. Inputs to the review include progress against quality objectives (on-time completion, snagging, documentation rates), results of recent audits, client and contractor feedback, staff suggestions, and a review of changes in regulatory or contractual environment.

Gareth presents a summary of findings and proposals, with Lee, Joanne, and Ricky present for feedback and operational insight. All major decisions — such as revised objectives, changes to roles, or process amendments — are agreed collaboratively, with Gareth having final decision rights. Outcomes are converted into action points with timelines and assigned responsibilities.

Review minutes and decisions are distributed to all relevant staff. Implementation of agreed improvements is tracked and reported back to Gareth at agreed milestones.

9. Continuous Improvement Procedure

Continuous improvement is sustained through deliberate review loops. All members of staff are encouraged to highlight process weaknesses, missed opportunities, or recurring issues. On completion of each project or after a major snag or quality failure, a short lessons-learned meeting is held, typically involving Gareth, Lee, and Joanne, to record what worked and what did not.

Recurring issues (e.g., persistent delays in material deliveries, incomplete documentation at handover, repeated snag types) are flagged by Joanne in monthly reporting to Gareth and Lee. Suggested changes may include process amendments, revised checklists, additional briefings, or new supplier or equipment arrangements.

Where improvement actions are identified, they are assigned an owner (usually Lee, Joanne, or Ricky), a deadline, and tracked on an improvement log. Effectiveness is verified at follow-up meetings. Gareth oversees that improvements are both implemented and effective, adapting them as necessary with operational feedback.

Major process changes, or those affecting external client requirements, are documented, communicated to the involved staff, and, where appropriate, integrated into formal procedures or checklists. This ensures changes are embedded in future projects, reducing error repetition and raising the standard of each job.